

SUBMISSION REQUIREMENT 2

Project Timeline

Estimated delivery schedule for design, build, testing, deployment, and handover of the production-ready application system.

Project Type	Full multi-role production build
Recommended Duration	14 weeks
Document Date	4 May 2026

The earlier two-month expectation is too tight for the confirmed scope if POPIA controls, auditability, workflow gating, and role separation are implemented properly from the start.

SCHEDULE

1. Revised Delivery Estimate

A realistic production estimate is **14 to 18 weeks**. The lower end assumes fast stakeholder feedback, no major external system integrations, and stable scoring rules. The upper end allows for UAT revisions, policy/legal review feedback, and additional security hardening before launch.

2 weeks discovery and architecture	8 weeks core feature delivery	2 weeks hardening and UAT	2-6 weeks contingency and launch prep
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2. Week-by-Week Milestones

Week	Primary Outcome
1	Workflow discovery, POPIA data classification, requirements confirmation, scoring rubric confirmation.
2	Solution architecture, database schema, RBAC matrix, audit/event design, infrastructure baseline.
3	Authentication, session management, user administration, staff role assignment.
4	Applicant account flow, eligibility gate, consent capture, application reference generation.
5	Main application form, mandatory document upload rules, duplicate submission prevention.
6	Essay review workflow, reviewer isolation, timestamped scoring and audit events.
7	Academic scoring workflow, subject-level capture, automatic averages, reviewer-owned records.
8	Document verification stage, mandatory checklist, missing-document blocker logic.
9	Master scorecard, shortlist dashboard, rank ordering, filter and export capability.
10	Interview stage, scoring sheet administration, notes capture, final list preparation logic.
11	Final decision stage, approval/rejection/standby outcomes, applicant communication workflow.
12	Data export, deletion workflow, breach-response support, admin ZIP download tooling.
13	Security hardening, audit review, penetration-test remediation, performance tuning.
14	UAT completion, deployment rehearsal, handover pack, training session delivery.

15-18	Contingency for change requests, policy updates, launch support, or phased go-live.
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DELIVERY

3. Milestone Structure

Milestone A: Foundation
Weeks 1 to 3

- requirements lock
- architecture and schema
- identity and staff roles

Milestone B: Applicant Intake
Weeks 4 to 5

- eligibility gate
- consent and application forms
- document submission controls

Milestone C: Review Engine
Weeks 6 to 10

- essay review
- academic scoring
- document verification, scorecard, interview stage

Milestone D: Decision and Launch
Weeks 11 to 14+

- final outcomes and communications
- export, deletion, hardening, UAT
- deployment and handover

4. Testing and Sign-Off

Testing Layer	What It Covers
Unit and service tests	Score calculations, workflow transitions, authorization rules, validation rules.
Integration tests	API to database behavior, document metadata handling, audit logging creation.
UAT	Role-by-role scenario walkthroughs with staff users and shortlisted end-to-end applicant journeys.
Security review	Session handling, access boundary checks, export/deletion flows, log coverage, incident readiness.

5. Handover Scope

The handover pack should include:

- source code and build instructions

- database schema and migration history
- deployment and rollback runbook
- environment variable and secret inventory
- administrator guide and user guide
- architecture summary and POPIA control summary
- training session or recorded walkthrough
- open issues register and support transition notes

Recommended commercial framing: treat handover as a formal milestone, not an informal closeout. This system is operationally sensitive and should not be considered complete without deployment documentation, admin training, and support transition notes.